



WHAT'S NEW ON THE TRAIL

There's progress around every corner. Discover the latest additions and ongoing projects bringing new life to Willow Waterhole's trails and greenspace.



MEET OUR NEWEST LANDMARK

There's a new resident at Willow Waterhole, standing tall, bright blue, and impossible to miss! Installed at Heron Lake's scenic Lookout Point, our 12-foot Blue Heron sculpture by Texas artist Jeffie Brewer blends art, education, and environmental awareness into one eye-catching feature.

Crafted from steel in vivid blue hue, the sculpture blends realism and whimsy, representing our commitment to preserving and protecting this oasis of greenspace for both the community and wildlife to enjoy, while honoring the Great Blue Heron that inspired our new logo.

It now serves as a wayfinding landmark, a favorite photo op, and a reminder of beauty we're working to protect.

Find it along the trail at Heron Lake

Snap a photo with our new friend and tag us!
[#willowwaterhole](#)

VOLUNTEERS OF THE WATERHOLE

April was a powerful month of service with volunteers showing up from across Houston to restore trails, remove litter, plant trees, and represent our mission in the community. From scout troops, nonprofit partners, corporate teams, and individual volunteers, all were united by a shared commitment to caring for Willow Waterhole.



OUR ACCOMPLISHMENTS

Here's what we accomplished together:

- 6 volunteer events
- Over 500 volunteers hours
- More than 170 volunteers engaged
- 150 native trees planted
- Dozens of bags of trash removed from trails and lake edges
- Weed removal and trail clearing
- Nearly \$16k worth of time contributed through volunteer service

We're incredibly grateful for the time, energy, and care our volunteers brought to Willow Waterhole during Earth Month. Your impact continues to shape every trail, tree, and blooming prairie.



Click below to see how you can make an impact as a volunteer!

[LEARN MORE](#)

FLORA & FAUNA SPOTLIGHT

Each issue, we will shine a light on a fascinating resident, from rooted natives to winged visitors and everything in between. Keep an eye out next time you're on the trails-- you just might spot them yourself!



Photo credit: Brad Imhoff

EASTERN BLUEBIRD

Eastern Bluebirds have become an increasingly common sight at Willow Waterhole in recent years. One was recently spotted near Scout Lake, just steps away from four new bird boxes installed through a recent Eagle Scout project.

Once in decline due to competition with invasive species like European Starlings and House Sparrows, Eastern Bluebird populations have rebounded thanks to nest box programs like this one.

Here's more about these bright and beloved birds:

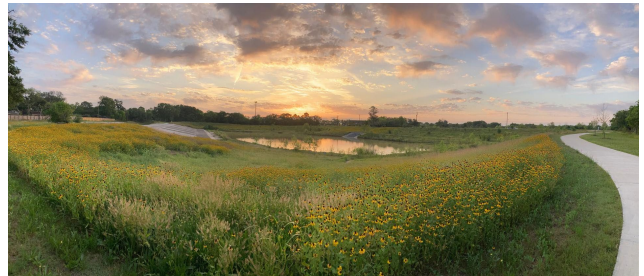
- **Color Magic:** Their brilliant blue color isn't from pigment, it's a result of feather structure scattering light. That's why their shade can look different depending on the lighting.
- **Nesting:** They are cavity nesters, relying on old tree holes or specifically designed bird boxes.
- **Range:** Bluebirds are year-round residents in southeast Texas. In colder climates, they migrate south for the winter.

MAKE AN IMPACT

Explore the many ways your can support Willow Waterhole and help make a lasting impact where nature and community thrive.

Supporting Willow Waterhole goes beyond one-time donations. From monthly giving and employer match programs to legacy gifts, in-kind donations, and even sponsorships, there are many ways to make a lasting difference.

Every contribution, big or small, helps us protect this 291-acre urban oasis for wildlife, recreation, and the community.



WAYS TO GIVE

- Become a Member
- Make a One-Time or Monthly Donation
- Honor a Loved One
- Corporate Matching Gifts
- Donor-Advised Funds (DAFs)
- IRA Charitable Distributions
- Planned Giving

Click below to explore all the ways you can give and grow your impact.

[LEARN MORE](#)

BOARD MEMBER SPOTLIGHT

Take a closer look at the people who make Willow Waterhole thrive. Our board members' dedication helps bring our mission to life.

HAZEL POTVIN

Advisory Board Member

As the visionary founder of the +360-square-meter Native Prairie Garden at Willow Waterhole Greenspace Conservancy (WWGC). In 2017, she transformed a bare plot into a vibrant habitat of native Texas wildflowers and grasses.

Hazel previously served on the board of the Houston Chapter of the Native Prairie Association of Texas and chaired both the Westbury Community Garden and the Westbury Greenspace Beautification Committee. Her passion for plants, rooted in her childhood on a Massachusetts dairy farm, has helped shape and beautify spaces across the Westbury community.

Her legacy lives on in every bloom. Through her dedication, she's sparked joy, stewardship, and connection, one wildflower at a time.



STAY CONNECTED

Your support keeps Willow Waterhole growing. Every dollar and every volunteer hour makes a difference. Whether you're ready to dig in or give back, we invite you to be part of what's next.

[DONATE NOW](#)

[SIGN UP TO VOLUNTEER](#)



Our Contact Information

Willow Waterhole Greenspace
Conservancy

5600 S. Willow Drive, STE 113
Houston, TX 77035

281-990-1459

<https://www.willowwaterhole.org/>

